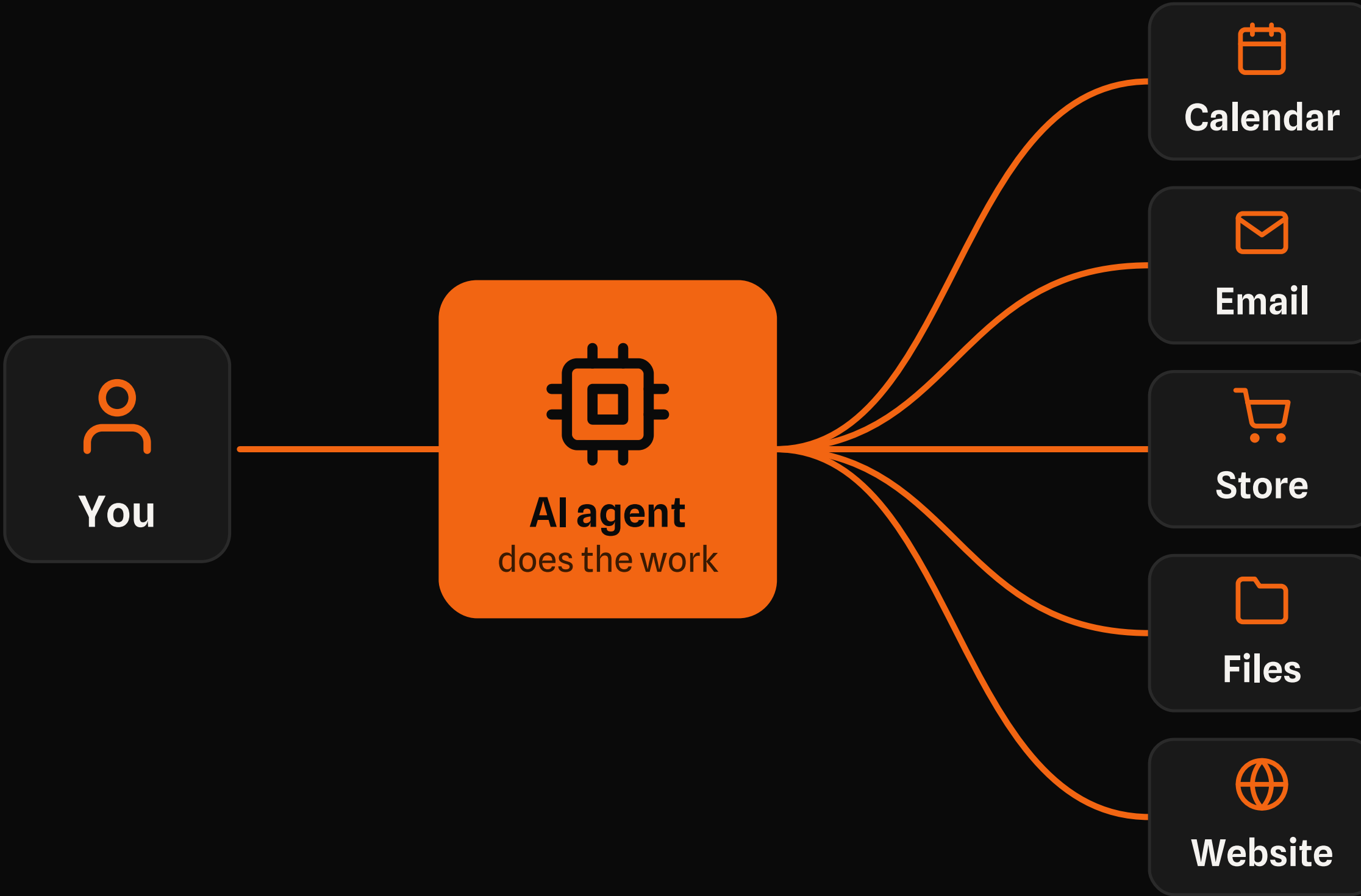


STOP CHATTING. START DELEGATING.

AI (Artificial Intelligence) that answers questions is old news. Tonight is about AI that **does the work** — and the handful of tools Greg and Patricia use every day.



WHO WE ARE

OPERATORS, NOT VENDORS.

Patricia and Greg — a father-daughter team running two e-commerce brands from Oakville since 2014: **GearTOP** (sun protection) and **TapeGeeks** (athletic recovery). Everything we show tonight comes from work we do in our own companies.

Greg is a mechanical engineer with **zero coding background**. At age 55, he built two App Store apps with AI. If we can, you can.



1997 – 2011

Engineer → manager of a 70-person department



2014

GearTOP & TapeGeeks launched with Patricia

Amazon, Shopify, wholesale · \$2M+ in ads managed



2024

All-in on AI — replaced \$75–125K a year of agency work

Custom tools, automations, dashboards



2025

SunUp & RunMate Pro live in the App Store

12 projects shipped, no formal coding



2026

Race Director, Bronte Harbour Classic

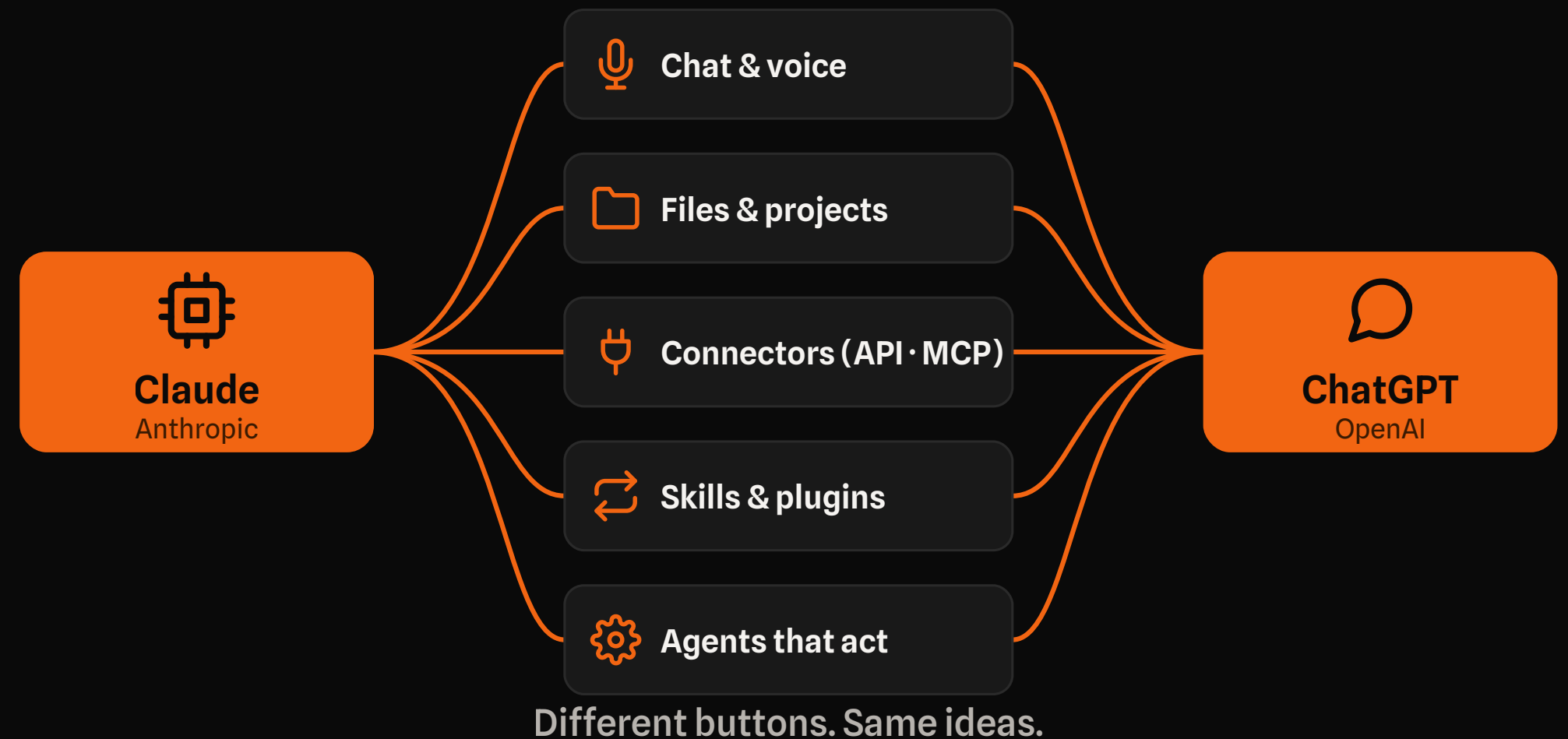
Co-lead, Bronte Runners (800+ members)

THE QUESTION EVERYONE ASKS FIRST

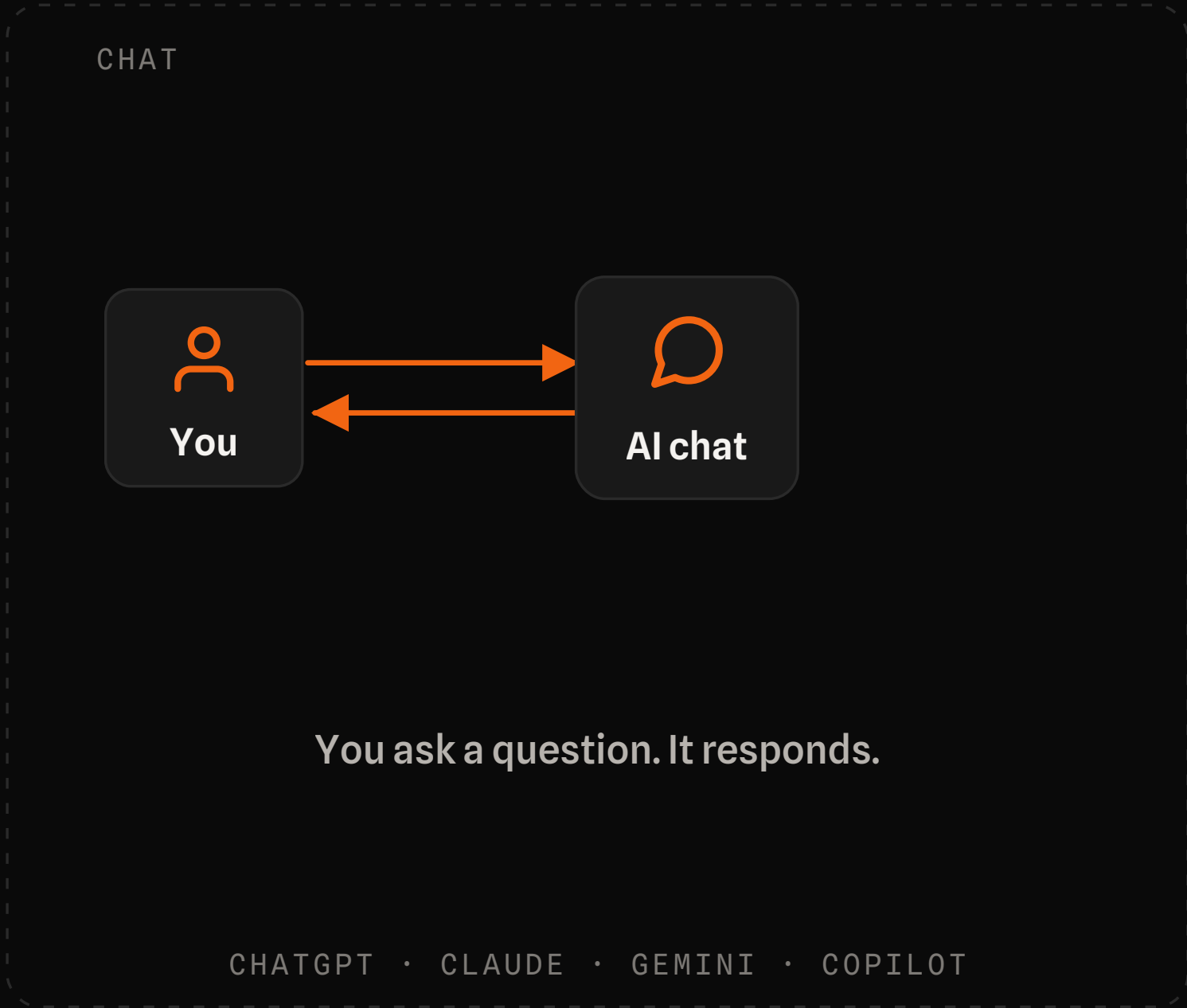
CLAUDE OR CHATGPT? PICK ONE. LEARN IT WELL.

Anthropic's **Claude** and OpenAI's **ChatGPT** are very similar systems. **Most of the core ideas we show tonight exist in both.** The names, buttons and exact features differ.

Learn one system well and the other takes an afternoon. **You may eventually use both** because each one develops useful features at a different pace.



SAME AI. TWO VERY DIFFERENT JOBS.



The next four words are all about those orange wires — **how an AI gets safely connected to your real tools.**

API

THE DOOR BETWEEN TWO SYSTEMS.

API stands for **Application Programming Interface**. It is the door one piece of software uses to enter another system and exchange information.

It's been around for decades. **It is not an AI thing** — AI can simply use the same doors.

APIS YOU ALREADY USE EVERY DAY

- Uber the map inside is Google Maps, over an API
- Stripe / Square every "Pay now" button
- Shopify → QuickBooks orders land in your books
- Calendly → Google Calendar bookings appear by themselves
- Weather on your phone pulled from a weather service



WORD 2 OF 4

MCP

THE DIRECTORY FOR YOUR AI EMPLOYEE.

MCP stands for Model Context Protocol. It shows the AI which tools are available, what they can do, and the standard way to use them.

Think of AI as a **new employee walking into your company**. Email, calendar, Shopify and Google Drive are separate rooms. **APIs are the doors**. **MCP is the directory**. Your permissions still decide which rooms the employee may enter.

ROOMS GREG'S AI EMPLOYEE CAN ALREADY WALK INTO

- Gmail

Google Calendar

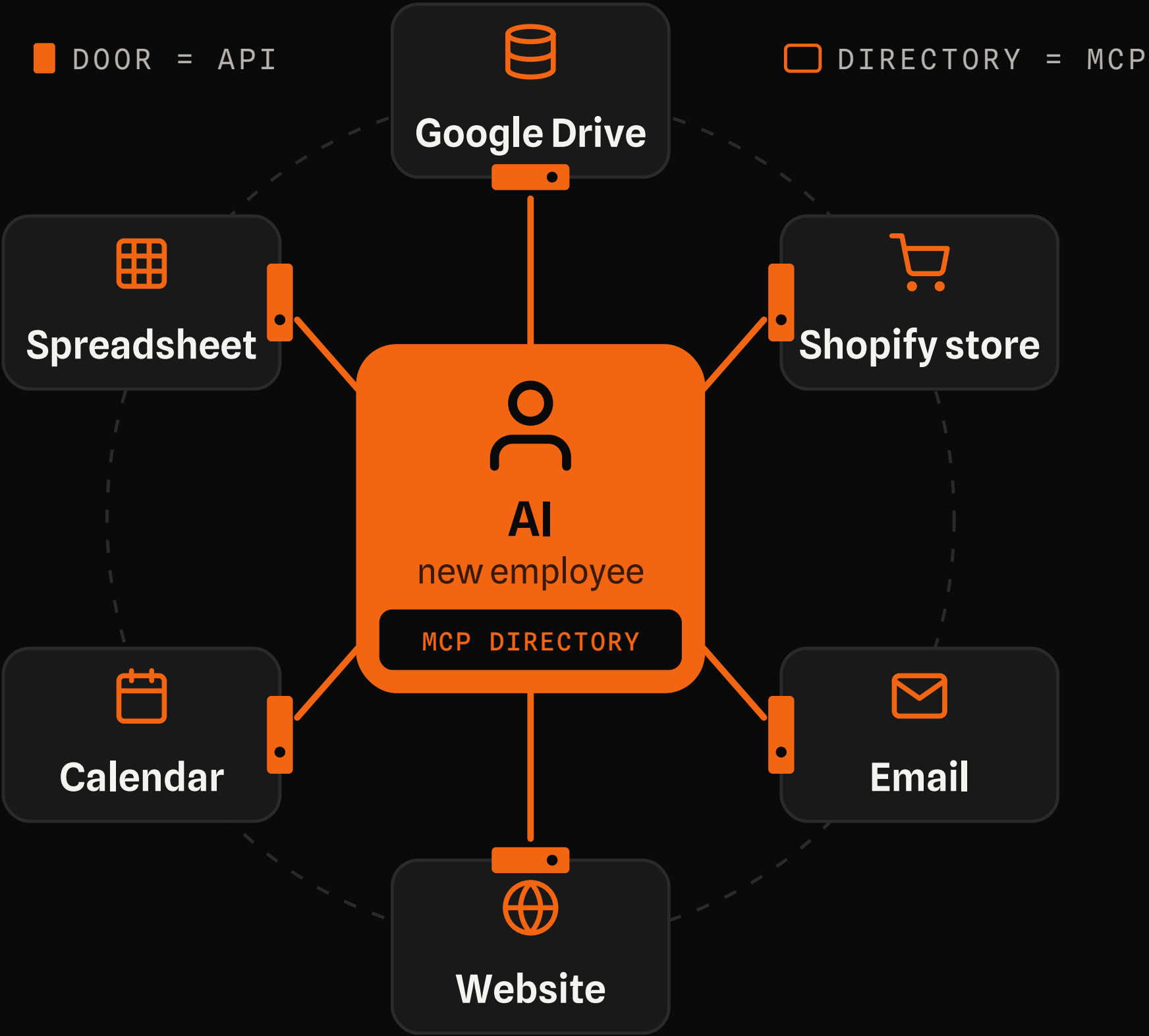
Google Drive

Slack

Shopify
- Klaviyo email marketing

ClickUp tasks

Microsoft 365
- Notion · Canva · Stripe · HubSpot also available



SKILL

THE SOP FOR YOUR AI EMPLOYEE.

A skill is a **saved set of instructions** for how you want a job done. Instead of explaining the process every time, you **save the procedure once** and reuse it whenever needed.

Think of it like giving an employee an **SOP (Standard Operating Procedure)**. It tells them what to do, in what order, what rules to follow, and what the finished work should look like.

SKILLS GREG RUNS EVERY WEEK

- Reply to a review** in our brand voice
- Voice memo** → **quote** ready to send
- Blog post** research to publish
- New product listing** Amazon + Shopify
- Video-to-Skill** tonight's demo



PLUGIN

A READY-MADE TOOLKIT FOR YOUR AI EMPLOYEE.

A plugin gives your AI ready-made tools and instructions for doing a job. Someone has already built the connections, which may use **APIs, MCP, or both**. You add the plugin, connect the services you want it to use, and give it permission to work.

Think of it like **handing a new employee a toolbox**. You don't build every tool yourself — you give them the kit and they can get to work.

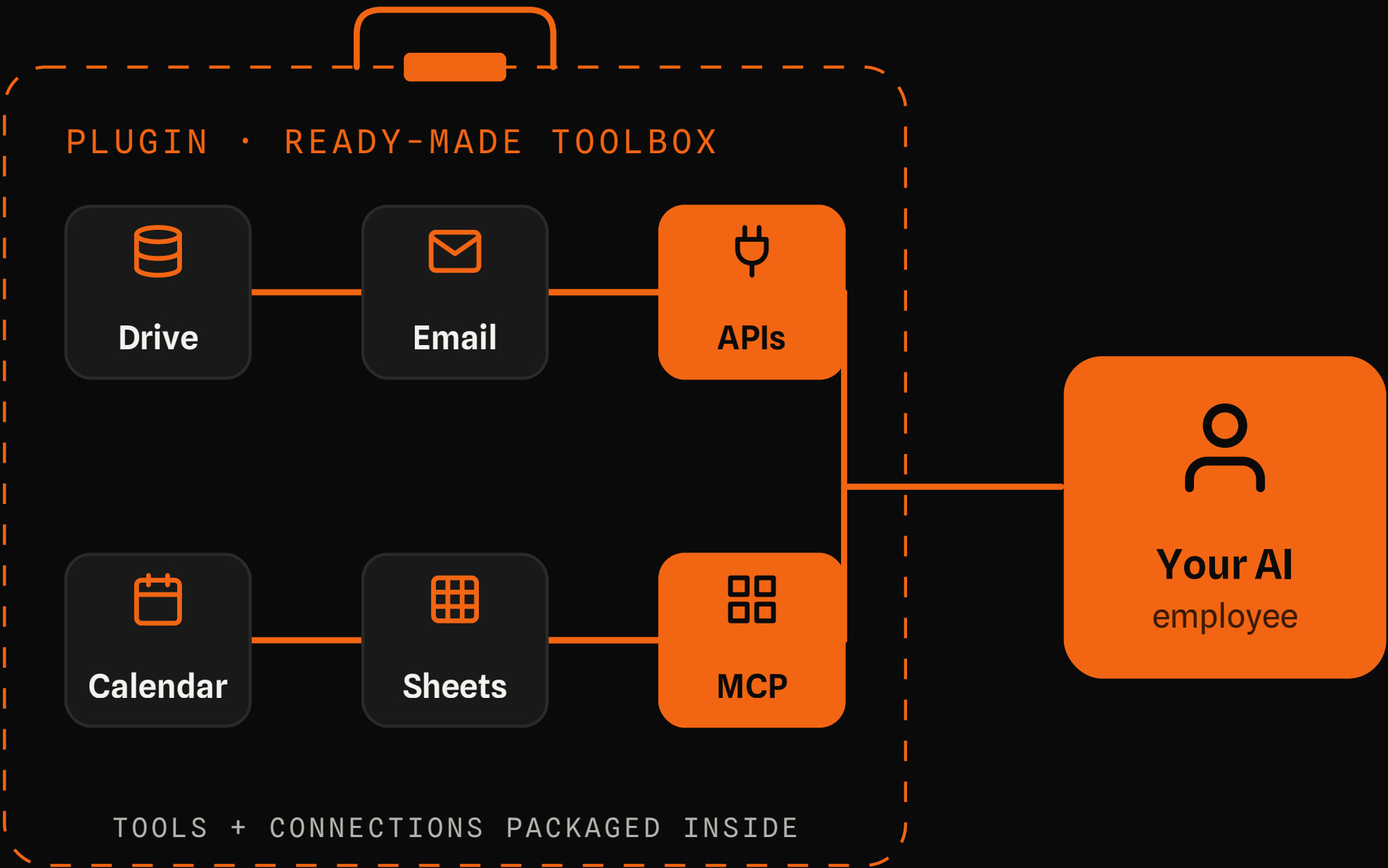
YOU ALREADY KNOW PLUGINS FROM EVERYDAY TOOLS

- Chrome extensions
- Shopify apps
- WordPress plugins

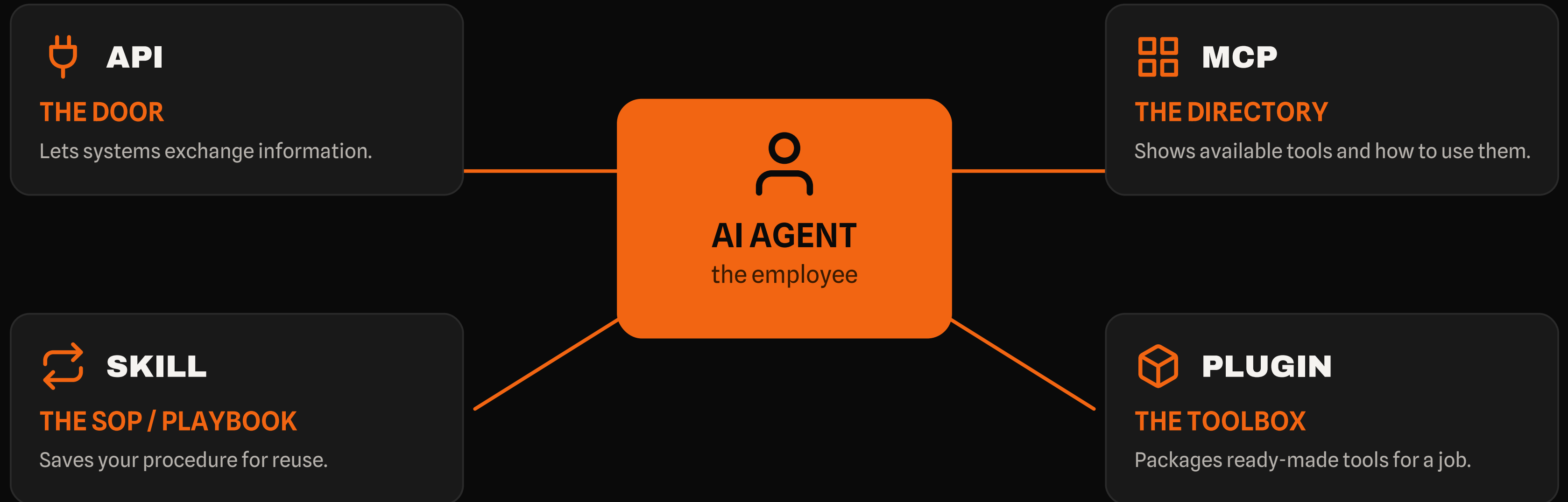
Zapier connects 7,000+ apps

AI PLUGINS USE THE SAME BASIC IDEA

- Claude plugins
- ChatGPT apps
- Cursor extensions



ONE AI EMPLOYEE. **FOUR THINGS TO REMEMBER.**



The agent is the employee. **These four things help the employee access your business and get work done.**

QUICK TIP 1 OF 3

STOP TYPING. TALK.

Most people type about **40 words a minute** and speak about **150**.
Dictation tools turn your voice into clean, formatted text in any app
— emails, quotes, notes, messages.

**WISPR FLOW**
What Greg uses today

PAID

**FLUIDVOICE**
Open source · [altic.dev/fluid](#)

FREE



Typing



≈ 40 words / min



Speaking

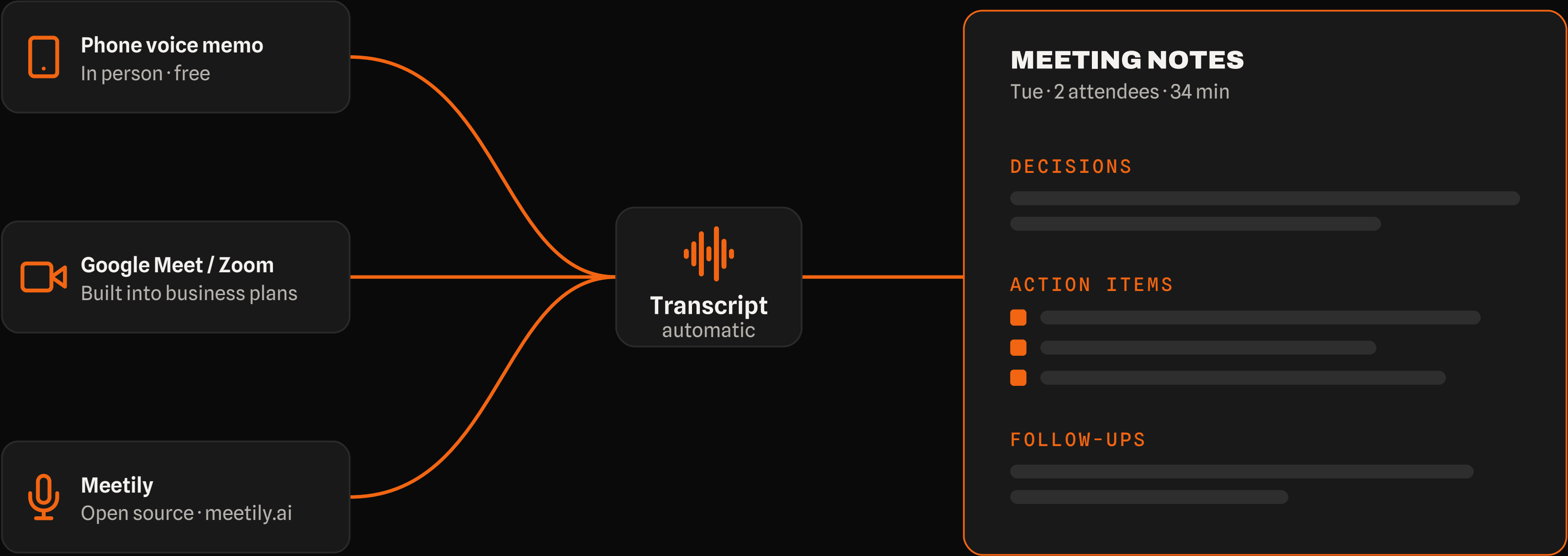


≈ 150 words / min

3–4× faster

Start free. Pay only if you outgrow it.

NEVER TAKE MEETING NOTES AGAIN.

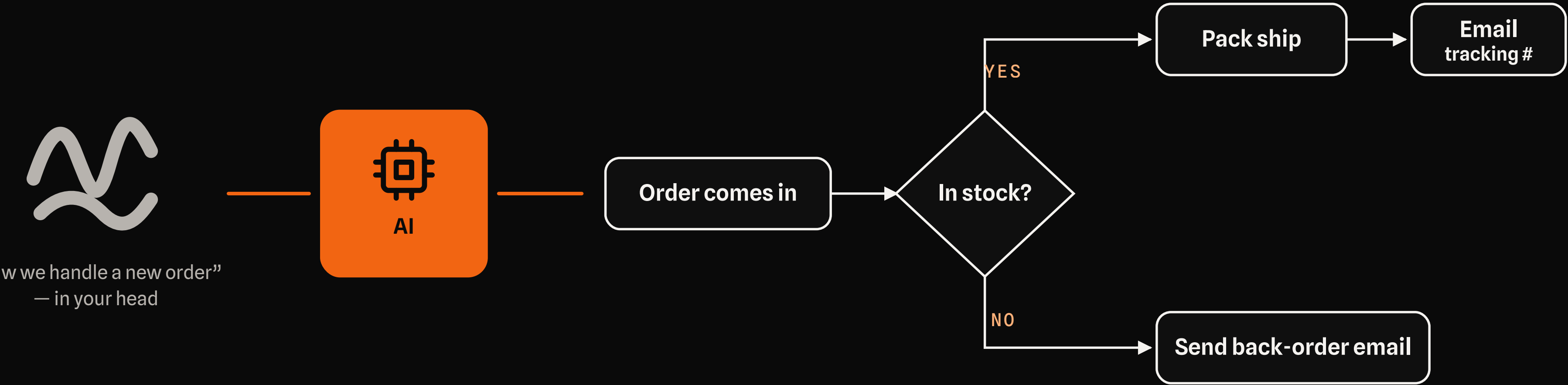


Record, transcribe, summarize. **You can start free, or use transcription already included in some meeting plans.**

Tell people before recording, and follow company policies and applicable privacy rules.

MAKE THE WORKFLOW EASY TO SEE AND GRASP.

Mermaid and **Excalidraw** help AI explain a workflow graphically, not just create a diagram. AI can map the process, show how each step connects and make complex work easier to understand at a glance. You will see this throughout the **Video-to-Skill** example.



“How we handle a new order”
— in your head

Diagrams make the workflow visible. **You can see how the AI works, not just read its explanation.**

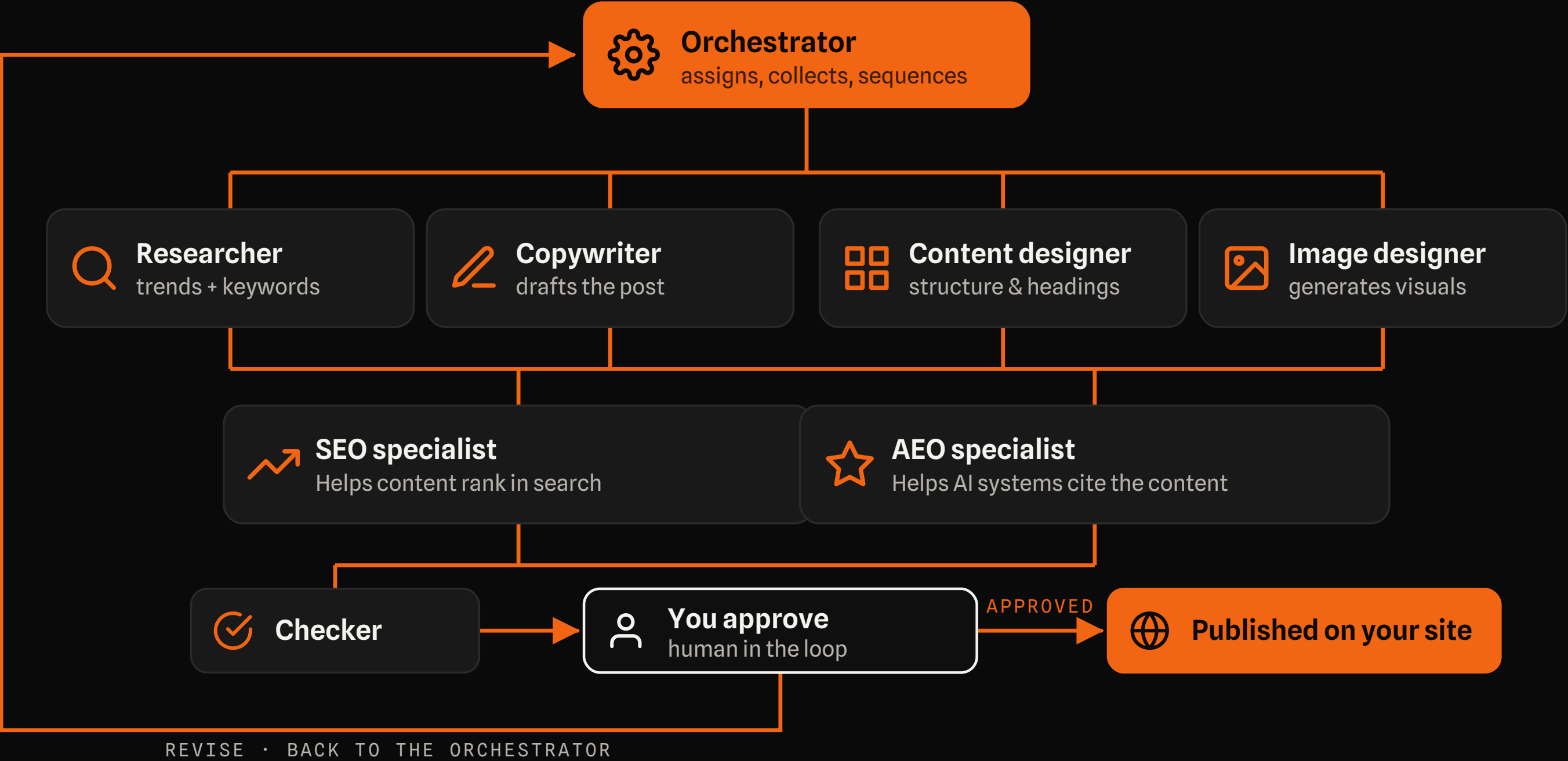
VIDEO-TO-SKILL

Feed it a YouTube video, podcast or webinar. It pulls the transcript, researches the speaker, and hands back structured knowledge — **in the form you pick.**



NEXT LEVEL: A TEAM OF AI AGENTS WRITES YOUR BLOG.

One supervisor hands out the work, specialists do their part, and a checker reviews the result. Then **you make the final call**: approve it for publication or send it back for revision.



BONUS · IF TIME ALLOWS

LET AI DRIVE YOUR BROWSER.

Browser agents can work through websites much like you do. They read pages, click, type and fill forms, including on sites with **no API** and **no MCP**. You supervise while the agent works through the steps.

**CLAUDE IN CHROME**
Anthropic · Chrome extension

PAID PLANS

**ATLAS AGENT**
OpenAI · browser agent

PAID PLANS

JOB

ITS CAN TAKE OFF YOUR PLATE

Pull last month's invoices

supplier portal

Fill in a government form

from your notes

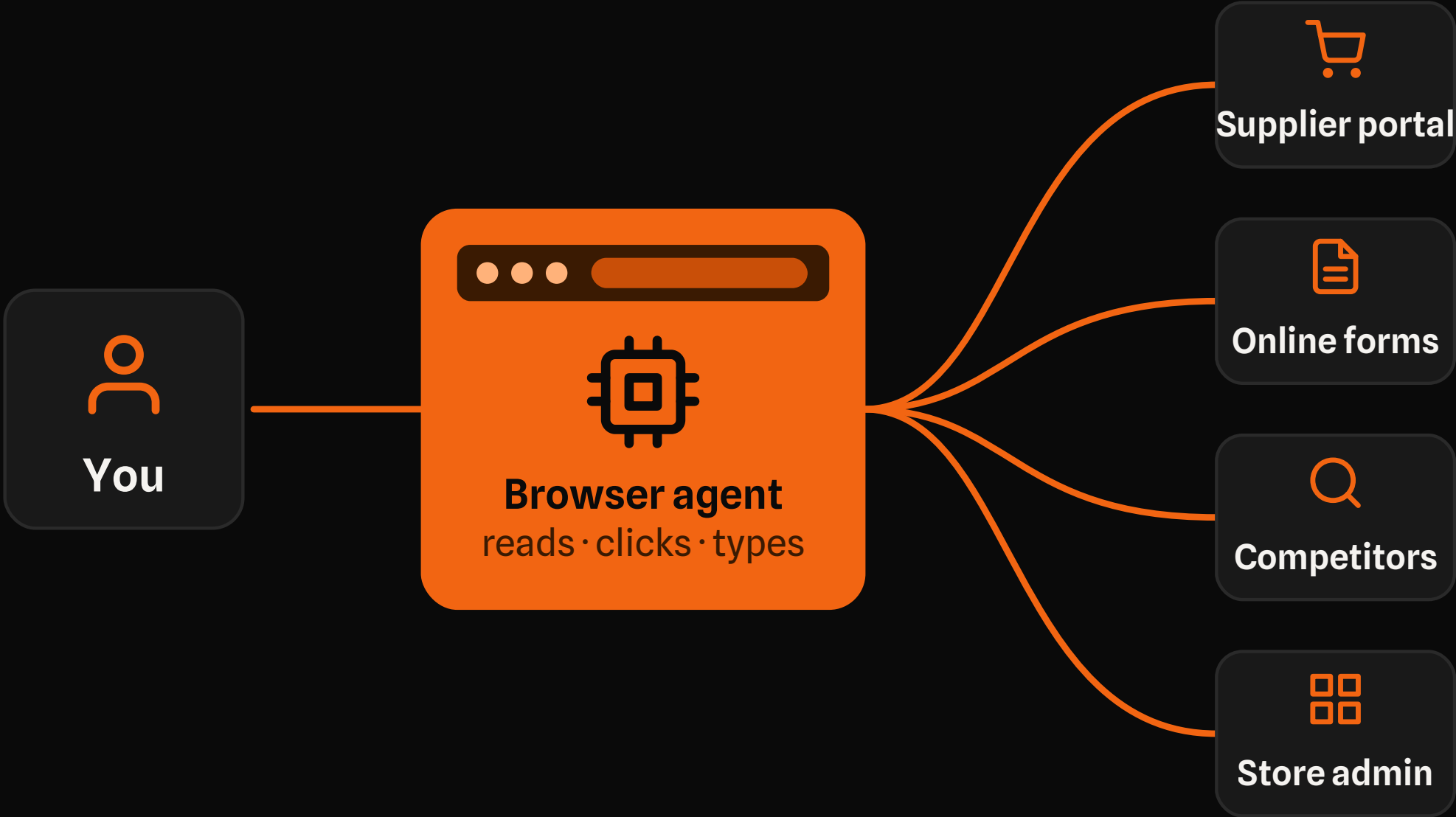
Compare prices on three sites

into a table

Update 20 product listings

your store admin

Watch it the first few times. **Never hand it your bank login.**



No API? No MCP? It uses the mouse and keyboard, like you would.

BONUS · WHERE THIS IS HEADING

STOP TYPING. JUST TALK TO IT.

Voice turns AI into a **colleague you can think out loud with**. On desktop, agentic modes can combine that conversation with computer control. You describe the job, then the agent works across apps and tools.

**CHATGPT VOICE**
OpenAI · phone & desktop app

IN THE APP

**CLAUDE VOICE**
Anthropic · phone app

IN THE APP

VOICE AND AGENTIC COMPUTER CONTROL

Think out loud on a walk

it writes the plan

Dictate a 10-minute brief

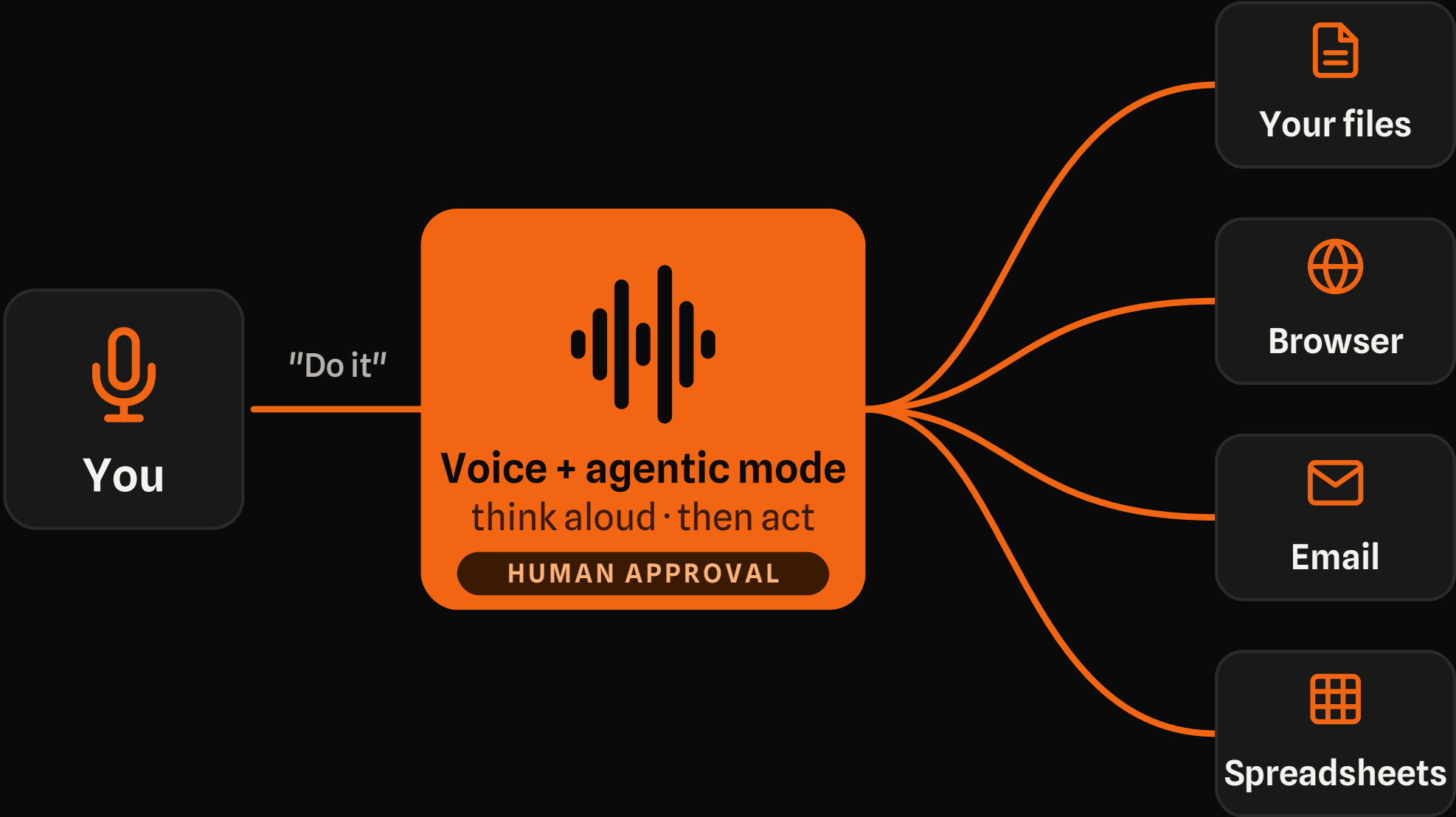
no typing

Share your screen

talk it through

"Reconcile last month's invoices"

agentic mode works across apps



Think out loud first. Confirm sensitive actions. Check the result.

Start with voice for thinking. **Require confirmation before sensitive or irreversible actions.**

OPEN DISCUSSION

WHAT'S THE ONE THING YOU WISH AI COULD HANDLE?

🔍 TO GET US STARTED

- What could you hand off in your business this month?
- How do you build a skill that's **unique to your business**?
- A newsletter that writes itself on a schedule
- The full blog pipeline: research → writing → images → publish
- Wiring AI straight into your website or Shopify store with MCP
- Building or updating a website without hiring a developer
- Finding and reaching new customers — lead lists, outreach, follow-ups
- What should next month's session cover?

✅ HONEST ANSWERS TO THE USUAL WORRIES

- **"Is my data safe?"** Data use depends on the tool, plan and settings. Check before connecting sensitive business information.
- **"It gave me a wrong answer once."** That's why AI plus a careful human beats AI alone. In our businesses, nothing important goes out unchecked.
- **"Will this replace my staff?"** Think about tasks before jobs. Start with repetitive work your team should not be spending time on.
- **"What does it cost?"** Most of tonight runs on \$0–60 a month.

SEE YOU NEXT MONTH

**PICK ONE THING FROM
TONIGHT.
TRY IT THIS WEEK.**

Grab the Video-to-Skill link, stay for a chat, and tell us what you want covered next time.

PATRICIA & GREG KOWALCZYK

GearTOP · TapeGeeks · AI for Business meetups

TAKE IT HOME TONIGHT

IT'S FREE. POINT YOUR CAMERA.

The full write-up and the skill file itself are on Greg's site. Install it, run it on the next podcast you'd normally forget.

gregkowalczyk.com/skills/video-to-skill

Want a copy of tonight's slides? Just let us know and we'll email them to you.



TAKE IT HOME TONIGHT • THE LINKS

EVERY TOOL FROM TONIGHT. ONE PAGE.

 CLAUDE

The assistant behind most of tonight — chat, Cowork, Claude Code, plugins and skills.

[claude.ai](#)

FREE PLAN • PRO FROM \$20/MO

 CHATGPT

OpenAI's assistant. Use ChatGPT Work for substantial multi-step work; Atlas Agent handles browser tasks.

[chatgpt.com](#)

FREE PLAN • PLUS FROM \$20/MO

 WISPR FLOW

Talk instead of type, in any app. 3–4× faster than the keyboard.

[wisprflow.ai](#)

FREE TIER • PRO FROM \$12/MO

 FLUIDVOICE

The free, open-source alternative to Wispr Flow. Same idea: talk, get clean text.

[altic.dev/fluid](#)

FREE • OPEN SOURCE

 MEETILY

Records and summarizes meetings on your own machine. Open source.

[meetily.ai](#)

FREE • OPEN SOURCE

 MERMAID

Type a process in plain text, get a flowchart. Built into ChatGPT and Claude.

[mermaid.live](#)

FREE

 EXCALIDRAW

Diagrams and SOPs with a hand-drawn look, created from your description.

[excalidraw.com](#)

FREE

 CURSOR

Run Claude and other models in one place, with different agents for different jobs.

[cursor.com](#)

FREE TIER • PRO FROM \$20/MO

Every one of these has a free tier. **Start free, pay only if you outgrow it.** Some links are referral links — they cost you nothing and help us keep these meetups free.